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AIR PURIFIER AND CONTROLLING METHOD THEREOF

Abstract

An air purifier may include a main body including an inlet and an outlet; a fan arranged in the main body; a solar cell arranged on a first side of the main body; a first light sensor arranged on a second side, which is different from the first side; a second light sensor arranged on a third side, which is different from the first and second sides; a driver arranged to rotate the main body; and a controller configured to control the fan to suck air into the main body through the inlet and discharge the air out of the main body through the outlet, and control the driver to rotate the main body based on an output signal from the first light sensor and an output signal from the second light sensor.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION [0001] This application is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/575,763, filed on Jan. 14, 2022 which is a bypass continuation application of International Application No. PCT/KR2021/019551 filed on Dec. 22, 2021, which claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119 from Korean Patent Application No. 10-2021-0034229 filed on Mar. 16, 2021, the disclosures of which are incorporated herein by reference in their entirety.

BACKGROUND

1. Field

[0002] The disclosure relates to an air purifier and method of controlling the same, and more particularly, to an air purifier including a solar cell and method for controlling the same.

2. Background

[0003] Air purifiers are devices for sucking up indoor air, purifying and discharging the air. Air purification refers to proper control over the indoor air.

[0004] The air purifier may control the cleanliness of the indoor air by removing contaminants in the air. The air purifier may remove germs, viruses, mold, fine dust, and chemicals which cause offensive odor in the air sucked up.

[0005] The air purifier may include a filter for purifying contaminated indoor air. The air sucked into the air purifier may be purified into clean air with the contaminants removed while passing through the filter, and the purified air may be discharged out of the air purifier.

[0006] For purifying operation of the air purifier, there is a need to measure the contamination level of space to be purified. To measure the contamination level of the space to be purified, the air purifier may include a particle sensor that emits a laser beam to particles contained in the air and then measures the contamination level based on an amount of beams scattered by the particles.

[0007] The air purifier needs to be constantly activated to control the cleanliness of the space to be purified. Hence, the air purifier may consume a lot of power.

SUMMARY

[0008] The disclosure provides an air purifier including a solar cell and a battery, and a method of controlling the air purifier.

[0009] The disclosure also provides an air purifier with a solar cell rotationally movable toward the sun, and a method of controlling the air purifier.

[0010] The disclosure also provides an air purifier for receiving power from one of a battery and an external power source based on a charge rate of the battery, and a method of controlling the air purifier.

[0011] According to an aspect of the disclosure, an air purifier includes a main body configured to be rotatable and including an inlet and an outlet; a fan arranged in the main body; a solar cell arranged on a first side of the main body, the first side extending along a first plane; a first light

sensor arranged on a second side of the main body and configured to measure an intensity of light received by the first sensor, the second side extending along a second plane, the first plane and the second plane being different from each other; a second light sensor configured to measure an intensity of light received by the second light sensor, the second light sensor arranged on a third side of the main body, the third side extending along a third plane, the third plane being different from the first plane and second plane; a driver arranged to rotate the main body; and a processor configured to control the fan to suck air into the main body through the inlet and discharge the air out of the main body through the outlet, and control the driver to rotate the main body based on an output signal from the first light sensor corresponding to the measured intensity of light received by the first light sensor and an output signal from the second light sensor corresponding to the measured intensity of light received by the second light sensor so that the solar cell is positioned toward a light source.

[0012] According to an aspect of the disclosure, a method of controlling an air purifier includes sucking air into a main body through an input arranged at the main body; discharging air out of the main body through an outlet arranged at the main body; generating power using a solar cell arranged on a first side of the main body, the first side extending along a first plane; and rotating the main body so that the solar cell is positioned toward a light source, based on an output signal of a first light sensor, the output signal corresponding to an intensity of light received by the first light sensor, the first light sensor arranged on a second side of the main body, the second side extending along a second plane, the first plane being different from the second plane and an output signal of a second light sensor, the output signal of the second light sensor corresponding to an intensity of light received by the second light sensor, the second light sensor arranged on a third side of the main body, the third side extending along a third plane, the third plane being different from the first plane and second plane.

[0013] According to an aspect of the disclosure, an air purifier includes a main body including an inlet and an outlet; a fan arranged in the main body; a contamination sensor configured to detect a density of contaminants in the air; a solar cell arranged on a first side of the main body; a battery electrically connected to the solar cell; an adapter configured to receive power from an external power source; a power circuit configured to supply power to the fan from one of the battery and the adapter; and a controller configured to control the fan to suck air into the main body through the inlet and discharge the air out of the main body through the outlet. The controller may control the power circuit to provide power to the fan from the external power source based on a density of the contaminants based on an output signal from the contamination sensor being larger than a reference density and a charge rate of the battery being less than a reference charge rate.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0014] The above and other objects, features and advantages of the present disclosure will become more apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art by describing in detail exemplary embodiments thereof with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which:

[0015] FIG. 1 illustrates an external appearance of an air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0016] FIG. 2 illustrates a cross-section A-A' shown in FIG. 1.

[0017] FIG. 3 is an exploded view of the air purifier of FIG. 1 according to the embodiment.

[0018] FIG. 4 illustrates a solar cell arranged on the rear side of an air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0019] FIG. 5 illustrates detachment of a solar panel from the top side of an air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0020] FIG. 6 is an exploded view of a first connector to be installed on the top side of an air

purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0021] FIG. 7 illustrates a lower cover of a solar panel to be coupled to an air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0022] FIG. 8 is an exploded view of a second connector to be installed on a lower cover of a solar panel coupled to an air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0023] FIG. 9 illustrates coupling of a first connector of an air purifier with a second connector of a solar panel, according to another embodiment of the disclosure.

[0024] FIG. 10 illustrates an air purifier arranged on a supporting plate, according to an embodiment.

[0025] FIG. 11 illustrates a cabinet bottom side of an air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0026] FIG. 12 illustrates an air purifier arranged on another air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0027] FIG. 13 illustrates an air purifier rotated on another air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0028] FIG. 14 illustrates a solar cell and a battery included in an air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0029] FIG. 15 illustrates a configuration of an air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0030] FIG. 16 illustrates a power circuit included in an air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0031] FIG. 17 illustrates an operation of an air purifier according to an embodiment.

[0032] FIG. 18 illustrates light incidence to an air purifier according to an embodiment.

[0033] FIG. 19 illustrates rotation of an air purifier according to an embodiment.

[0034] FIG. 20 illustrates an operation of an air purifier according to an embodiment.

[0035] FIG. 21 illustrates an air purifier receiving power from a battery, according to an embodiment.

[0036] FIG. 22 illustrates an air purifier receiving power from an adapter, according to an embodiment.

[0037] FIGS. 23A and 23B illustrate an operation of an air purifier according to an embodiment.

[0038] FIG. 24 illustrates an air purifier providing power to another air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0039] FIG. 25 illustrates an air purifier receiving power from another air purifier, according to an embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS

[0040] Like numerals may refer to like elements throughout the specification.

[0041] Not all elements of embodiments of the disclosure will be described, and description of what are commonly known in the art or what overlap each other in the embodiments will be omitted.

[0042] The terms as used throughout the specification, such as “~part”, “~module”, “~member”, “~block”, etc., may be implemented in software and/or hardware, and a plurality of “~parts”, “~modules”, “~members”, or “~blocks” may be implemented in a single element, or a single “~part”, “~module”, “~member”, or “~block” may include a plurality of elements.

[0043] It will be further understood that the term “connect” or its derivatives refer both to direct and indirect connection, and the indirect connection includes a connection over a wireless communication network.

[0044] Throughout the specification, the term “include (or including)” or “comprise (or comprising)” is inclusive or open-ended and does not exclude additional, unrecited components, elements or method steps, unless otherwise stated.

[0045] Throughout the specification, when it is said that a member is located “on” another member, it implies not only that the member is located adjacent to the other member but also that a third member exists between the two members. The terms “front”, “top or upper”, “bottom or lower”, “left” and “right” as herein used are defined with respect to the drawings, but the terms may not

restrict the shape and position of the respective components.

[0046] It will be understood that, although the terms first, second, third, etc., may be used herein to describe various elements, components, regions, layers and/or sections, these elements, components, regions, layers and/or sections should not be limited by these terms. These terms are only used to distinguish one element, component, region, layer or section from another region, layer or section.

[0047] Throughout the specification, it is to be understood that the singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” include plural references unless the context clearly dictates otherwise.

[0048] Reference numerals used for method steps are just used for convenience of explanation, but not to limit an order of the steps. Thus, unless the context clearly dictates otherwise, the written order may be practiced otherwise.

[0049] The principle and embodiments of the disclosure will now be described with reference to accompanying drawings.

[0050] FIG. 1 illustrates external appearance of an air purifier, according to an embodiment. FIG. 2 illustrates a cross-section A-A' shown in FIG. 1. FIG. 3 is an exploded view of the air purifier of FIG. 1 according to the embodiment.

[0051] Referring to FIGS. 1, 2 and 3, an air purifier 1 may include a main body 10 provided in the form of a rectangular parallelepiped or a cube. The main body 10 is not, however, limited to the rectangular parallelepiped or the cube form, and may be provided in various forms such as a polyhedron, a cylinder, etc.

[0052] The main body 10 may include a cabinet that forms an external appearance. The cabinet may include a cabinet top side 13, a cabinet left side 14, a cabinet right side 15, and a cabinet bottom side 17. The cabinet top side 13, the cabinet left side 14, and the cabinet right side 15 may be integrally formed. The cabinet top side 13, the cabinet left side 14, the cabinet right side 15, and the cabinet bottom side 17 may define top, left, right, and bottom of the main body 10, respectively.

[0053] The main body 10 may further include a front panel 20 with its front edges arranged to be opened, and a rear panel 30 with its rear edges arranged to be opened.

[0054] The air purifier 1 may include an inlet 12 formed at the main body 10 to bring in outside air distributed outside to the inside of the air purifier 1, specifically, to the inside of the main body 10. The air purifier 1 may include an outlet 11 formed at the main body 10 to discharge the air brought in through the inlet 12.

[0055] The inlet 12 and the outlet 11 may be formed at different sides or at the same side of the main body 10. For example, as shown in FIG. 1, the inlet 12 may be formed on the rear side of the main body 10, and the outlet 11 may be formed on the front side of the main body 10. Specifically, the inlet 12 may be arranged to surround the rear panel 30, and the outlet 11 may be arranged to surround the front panel 20.

[0056] The air purifier 1 may include a filter unit 40 or fan assembly 50 arranged in the main body 10.

[0057] The fan assembly 50 may suck up air outside the air purifier 1 through the inlet 12 to the inside of the main body 10 to force the air to pass through the filter unit 40. The fan assembly 50 may discharge the air filtered by the filter unit 40 out of the main body 10 through the outlet 11.

[0058] The air purifier 1 may further include a fan case 55 for containing and fixing the fan assembly 50 thereto. The fan case 55 may form a wind-blow fluid path 19 to guide an airflow created by the fan assembly 50 to the outlet 11 arranged in front of the fan case 55.

[0059] The wind-blow fluid path 19 may be defined as a fluid path in which air moved by the fan assembly 50 flows from the inlet 12 of the air purifier 1 to the outlet 11 of the air purifier 1.

[0060] The fan assembly 50 may include fan wings 51 that create an airflow inside the main body 10, a first motor 52 for rotating the fan wings 51, and a motor cover 53 that receives and fixes the first motor 52 thereto.

[0061] The first motor 52 may include a shaft 52a, which may be coupled to the fan wings 51 to

transfer power of the first motor **52** to the fan wings **51**. The shaft **52a** may extend in a forward or backward direction. The first motor **52** may receive power from a driving circuit and rotate in response to the received power.

[0062] The fan wings **51** may have a rotation axis R in parallel with the forward or backward direction. The fan wings **51** may include a mixed flow fan. The fan wings **51** may include a turbo fan. The fan wings **51** may suck in air from behind, and discharge the air forward. The fan wings **51** may be covered by the fan case **55**.

[0063] The motor cover **53** may support the fan wings **51** so that the fan wings **51** are arranged in the fan case **55**. Specifically, as the motor cover **53**, to which the first motor **52** coupled with the fan wings **51** is fixed, is fastened to the fan case **55**, the fan wings **51** may be supported by the motor cover **53**. The motor cover **53** may include a cover bracket coupled to the fan case **55**.

[0064] The filter unit **40** may purify the air sucked in from the inlet **12**, and may be detachably installed in the main body **10**.

[0065] The air purifier **1** may further include a filter case **45** in which the filter unit **40** may be mounted. The filter case **45** may be arranged behind the fan case **55**. The filter case **45** and the fan case **55** may be covered by the cabinet.

[0066] The air purifier **1** may include the front panel **20** provided to be movable relative to the main body **10** to adjust the size of the outlet **11**. The front panel **20** may be arranged in front of the main body **10**. The front panel **20** may form e.g., the front of the external appearance of the air purifier **1**.

[0067] The outlet **11** may be formed between the front panel **20** and the cabinet of the main body **10**. For example, the outlet **11** may be defined as a gap formed between the front panel **20** and the cabinet of the main body **10** when the front panel **20** moves forward. The front panel **20** may increase the size of the outlet **11** by moving forward. The front panel **20** may reduce the size of the outlet **11** by moving backward again from a state of being moved forward by a certain length.

[0068] However, it is not limited thereto. The front panel **20** may be fixed not to be moved in front of the main body **10**, and the outlet **11** may be formed at the front panel **20** or the main body **10**. The front panel **20** may be integrally formed with the main body **10**.

[0069] The air purifier **1** may further include a guard frame **21** arranged between the front panel **20** and the main body **10**.

[0070] The guard frame **21** may be arranged to be spaced out from the outer edges of the front panel **20**. The guard frame **21** may have a shape corresponding to the front panel **20**. The guard frame **21** may be provided in the form that surrounds at least some of the outer edges of the front panel **20**.

[0071] The guard frame **21** may be arranged between the front panel **20** and the main body **10** to fix the front panel **20** to the main body **10**. For example, the front panel **20**, the guard frame **21** and the main body **10** may be fastened to each other through a structure with hooks and corresponding grooves. The fastening structure is not limited to the hook-groove structure, and there may be various structures such as screw-fastening.

[0072] The rear panel **30** may form the external appearance of the main body **10**. The rear panel **30** may form e.g., the rear side of the external appearance of the air purifier **1**.

[0073] The rear panel **30** may be spaced out from the cabinet of the main body **10**. The inlet **12** may be formed between the rear panel **30** and the cabinet of the main body **10**. For example, the inlet **12** may be defined as a gap formed between the rear panel **30** and the cabinet of the main body **10**.

[0074] The rear panel **30** may further include a guide flange **31** formed along the edges of the rear panel **30**. The guide flange **31** may protrude toward the main body **10** from the edges of the rear panel **30**. The rear panel **30** may be coupled to the main body **10** through a fastening structure formed at the guide flange **31**. The guide flange **31** may be provided in the form of substantially a loop.

[0075] The air purifier **1** may further include a guard flange **32** arranged between the rear panel **30**

and the main body **10**. The guard flange **32** may be arranged to be spaced out from the outer edges of the guide flange **31**. The guard flange **32** may be provided in a form corresponding to the guide flange **31**. The guard flange **32** may have a form that surrounds at least some of the outer edges of the guide flange **31**.

[0076] The guard flange **32** may be arranged between the rear panel **30** and the main body **10** to fix the rear panel, specifically, the guide flange **31** to the main body **10**. For example, the rear panel **30**, the guard flange **32** and the main body **10** may be fastened to each other through a structure with hooks and corresponding grooves. The fastening structure is not limited to the hook-groove structure, and there may be various structures such as screw-fastening.

[0077] FIG. **4** illustrates an air purifier with a solar cell arranged on the rear side, according to an embodiment.

[0078] The air purifier **1** may further include a solar cell **60** that is capable of generating power from the light.

[0079] The solar cell **60** may refer to a device capable of converting solar energy to electric energy. For example, when light having energy greater than in a forbidden bandwidth of the semiconductor is irradiated to a PN junction where the P-type semiconductor and the N-type semiconductor join, an electron and a hole may be produced at the PN junction. In this case, according to an electric field produced at the PN junction, the electron may move to the N-type semiconductor and the hole may move to the P-type semiconductor. With the electron moving to the N-type semiconductor and the hole moving to the P-type semiconductor, electromotive force may be generated across the semiconductor. In this case, the semiconductor may include silicon (Si), gallium arsenide (GaAs), cadmium sulfide (CdS), indium phosphorus (InP), or the like.

[0080] The air purifier **1** may further include a battery capable of storing power produced by the solar cell **60**, and a charging circuit for charging the battery using the power produced by the solar cell **60**.

[0081] The battery may include a pair of electrodes, and an electrolyte between the pair of electrodes. The battery may convert electric energy to chemical energy based on a voltage applied to the pair of electrodes and store the chemical energy. Furthermore, the battery may convert chemical energy to electric energy based on a voltage applied to the pair of electrodes and store the electric energy.

[0082] For example, the battery may store electric energy produced by the solar cell **60** or electric energy received from an external power source. Moreover, the battery may provide the electric energy to the air purifier **1**.

[0083] The solar cell **60** and the battery may be arranged in various positions at the air purifier **1**.

[0084] The solar cell **60** and the battery may be arranged at the rear panel **30** of the air purifier **1**, as shown in FIG. **4**. In other words, the solar cell **60** may be installed on the rear side of the air purifier **1**.

[0085] The user may usually place the air purifier **1** so that the outlet **11** of the air purifier **1** faces the inner side of an indoor space and the inlet **12** faces the outer side of the indoor space.

Accordingly, the outlet **11** of the air purifier **1** may face the center of the indoor space and the inlet **12** may face a wall or a window of the indoor space.

[0086] For example, when the air purifier **1** is placed near a window, the front panel **20** of the air purifier **1** may face the center of the indoor space and the rear panel **30** may face the window of the indoor space. Hence, the light may enter the rear panel **30**. Accordingly, a constant solar ray may be incident on the solar cell **60** installed on the rear panel **30**, and the solar cell **60** may constantly produce power during the daytime.

[0087] Furthermore, as the inlet **12** is formed to surround the rear panel **30**, the inlet **112** may not be blocked or interfered by the solar cell **60** even though the solar cell **60** is arranged on the rear panel **30**.

[0088] In this way, the solar cell **60** installed at the rear panel **30** on the rear side of the air purifier

1 may not block or interfere an airflow from the air purifier **1**, and may constantly produce power during the daytime.

[0089] The position in which the solar cell **60** is installed is not, however, limited to the rear panel **30**. For example, the solar cell **60** may be detachably attached to the top side of the air purifier **1**.

[0090] FIG. **5** illustrates detachment of a solar panel from the top side of an air purifier, according to an embodiment. FIG. **6** is an exploded view of a first connector to be installed on the top side of an air purifier, according to an embodiment. FIG. **7** illustrates a lower cover of a solar panel to be coupled to an air purifier, according to an embodiment. FIG. **8** is an exploded view of a second connector to be installed on a lower cover of a solar panel coupled to an air purifier, according to an embodiment. FIG. **9** illustrates coupling of a first connector of an air purifier with a second connector of a solar panel, according to another embodiment of the disclosure.

[0091] As shown in FIG. **5**, a solar panel **2** may be detachably attached to the top side of the air purifier **1**.

[0092] A first connector **110** may be arranged on the top side of the air purifier **1** to mechanically and electrically couple the air purifier **1** to the solar panel **2**.

[0093] The first connector **110** may be coupled to be rotatable relative to the main body **10** around a rotation axis **114** that is parallel to the top side of the main body **10**. To couple the solar panel **2** to the air purifier **1**, the user may push a portion of the first connector **110** and turn the first connector **110** relative to the main body **10**. Hence, the first connector **110** may be in a state in which a cover **119** is arranged inside the main body **10** and a first power terminal **112** is exposed to the outside of the main body **10**.

[0094] As shown in FIG. **6**, the first connector **110** may include a connection case **111** having top and bottom sides open, the cover **119** for covering the bottom of the connection case **111**, a shaft **117** for supporting the first connector **110** to be rotatable relative to the main body **10**, first and second shaft receivers **115** and **116** for rotatably supporting the shaft **117**, and a first terminal receiver **113**.

[0095] The connection case **111** may be provided in a form corresponding to a second connector of the solar panel **2**. The connection case **111** may be substantially shaped like a hemisphere and may cover the first power terminal **112** inside.

[0096] The connection case **111** may include an opening **111a** so that the first power terminal **112** may be connected to a second connector of the solar panel **2**. Furthermore, the connection case **111** may include a receiver supporting groove **111b** for supporting the first shaft receiver **115**.

[0097] The first power terminal **112** may be arranged in the first terminal receiver **113**.

[0098] The first power terminal **112** may be formed at the inner circumference formed in the middle of the top of the first terminal receiver **113**.

[0099] The first power terminal **112** may be electrically connected to the second connector **120** of the solar panel **2**. When the first connector **110** of the air purifier **1** is coupled to the second connector **120** of the solar panel **2**, the air purifier **1** may be electrically connected to the solar panel **2**. Once the air purifier **1** is electrically connected to the solar panel **2**, the solar panel **2** may provide power to the air purifier **1**.

[0100] The shaft **117** may support the first connector **110** so that the first connector **110** may be rotated relative to the main body **10**. The shaft **117** may be rotationally coupled to the first and second shaft receivers **115** and **116**.

[0101] The shaft **117** may include a wire through-hole **117a** through which a wire electrically connected to the first power terminal **112** may pass. The wire passing through the wire through-hole **117a** may be electrically connected to the power circuit of the air purifier **1**.

[0102] The first shaft receiver **115** may rotationally support a portion of the shaft **117**. The first shaft receiver **115** may include a first shaft groove **115a** to accommodate the shaft **117**. The first shaft receiver **115** may support the first power terminal **112**.

[0103] The second shaft receiver **116** may rotationally support the other portion of the shaft **117**.

The second shaft receiver **116** may include a second shaft groove **116** to accommodate the shaft **117**. The second shaft receiver **116** may support the cover **119**.

[0104] When the first power terminal **112** is arranged inside the main body **10**, the cover **119** may constitute a portion of the top of the main body **10**. Specifically, the cover **119** may be arranged to be exposed to the outside of the main body **10** when the air purifier **1** is used alone. In this case, the cover **119** may be positioned on the almost same plane as the top of the main body **10**.

Furthermore, the cover **119** may be arranged inside the main body **10** when the air purifier **1** is used with the solar panel **2** coupled thereto.

[0105] The solar panel **2** may be detachably arranged on the top of the air purifier **1**.

[0106] As shown in FIG. 5, the solar panel **2** may include the solar cell **60**, a battery **70**, and a bottom cover **2a**.

[0107] The solar cell **60** may be arranged on the top of the solar panel **2**. The solar cell **60** may convert solar energy to electric energy.

[0108] The battery **70** may be arranged inside the solar panel **2**. The battery **70** may store electric energy in the form of chemical energy by converting the electric energy to the chemical energy. Furthermore, a battery sensor may be arranged in the battery **70** for detecting an input or output current and an output voltage.

[0109] The bottom cover **2a** may be arranged under the solar panel **2**. The second connector **120** may be arranged at the bottom cover **2a** to be detachably coupled to the first connector **110** of the air purifier **1**.

[0110] As shown in FIGS. 7 and 8, the second connector **120** may include a lower case **121**, a supporting case **124** arranged inside the lower case **121**, and a second terminal receiver **123** arranged inside the supporting case **124**.

[0111] The lower case **121** may have substantially a cylindrical shape. The lower case **121** may support the supporting case **124**. The lower case **121** may cover the supporting case **124** arranged inside the internal space **121a**, and a second power terminal **122**. The supporting case **124** may be supported by the lower case **121**, and the second power terminal **122** may be arranged in an internal space **124a**.

[0112] The second power terminal **122** may be arranged in the second terminal receiver **123**.

[0113] A receiving space **123a** may be formed under the second terminal receiver **123** for receiving the first terminal receiver **113** of the first connector **110**. The second power terminal **122** may be arranged substantially in the middle of the receiving space **123a** to protrude from the base of the receiving space **123a**.

[0114] The second power terminal **122** may be electrically connected to the first power terminal **112**. Electric energy of the battery **70** may be provided to the air purifier through the second power terminal **122** and the first power terminal **112**.

[0115] The second terminal receiver **123** may be arranged inside the supporting case **124**. The second power terminal **122** may be arranged to keep electric connection with the first power terminal **112** even when the second power terminal **122** is rotated in a state of being connected to the first power terminal **112**.

[0116] In order for the air purifier **1** to receive power from the solar panel **2**, the first power terminal **112** of the first connector **110** may be exposed to the outside, as shown in FIG. 9. Specifically, the user may turn the first connector **110** around the rotation axis **114** by pushing the cover **119** arranged outside of the first connector **110**. This puts the first and second connectors **110** and **120** in a state as shown in FIG. 9.

[0117] After this, the user may couple the solar panel **2** onto the top of the air purifier **1**. The solar panel **2** may be coupled onto the top of the air purifier **1** in the downward direction. Hence, the first power terminal **112** may be electrically connected to the second power terminal **122**. In this case, the air purifier **1** may receive power from the solar panel **2** through the first power terminal **112** and the second power terminal **122**.

[0118] FIG. **10** illustrates an air purifier arranged on a supporting plate, according to an embodiment. FIG. **11** illustrates a cabinet bottom side of an air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0119] As shown in FIG. **10**, the air purifier **1** may be detachably installed on a supporting plate **3**.

[0120] The supporting plate **3** may support and/or fix the air purifier **1**.

[0121] The supporting plate **3** may also provide power to the air purifier **1**. For example, the supporting plate **3** may include a power line for receiving power from an external power source and an adapter for transforming the power received from the external power source. Of course, the air purifier **1** may also be directly connected to the power line and the adapter without being connected to the supporting plate **3**, and directly receive power from the external power source.

[0122] The first connector **110** may be arranged on the top of the supporting plate **3** to mechanically and electrically couple the air purifier **1** to the supporting plate **3**.

[0123] The first connector **110** arranged on the top of the supporting plate **3** may be identical to the first connector of the air purifier **1** as shown in FIGS. **5** and **6**. The first connector **110** may be fixed onto the top surface of the supporting plate **3** and may not be able to turn against the top surface of the supporting plate **3**. For example, the first connector **110** arranged on the top of the supporting plate **3** may include the connection case, the cover, the first terminal receiver, and the first power terminal. Compared to the first connector as shown in FIGS. **5** and **6**, the first connector **110** may not include the shaft and the shaft receiver.

[0124] The supporting plate **3** may provide power to the air purifier **1** through the first connector **110**.

[0125] The second connector **120** may be arranged on the bottom side of the air purifier **1** to mechanically and electrically couple the air purifier **1** to the supporting plate **3**. The second connector **120** may be arranged on the cabinet bottom side **17** of the air purifier **1**.

[0126] The second connector **120** arranged on the cabinet bottom side **17** may be identical to the second connector of the solar panel **2** as shown in FIGS. **7** and **8**. For example, the second connector **120** may include the lower case, the supporting case, the second terminal receiver, and the second power terminal.

[0127] A driving mechanism **80** for rotating the main body **10** may further be arranged on the cabinet bottom side **17**.

[0128] The second connector **120** arranged at the cabinet bottom side **17** may be coupled to the supporting plate **3** or the first connector **110** arranged on the top side of another air purifier. Some portions of the second connector **120** (e.g., the lower case, the supporting case, or the second terminal receiver) may be fixed to the main body **10**, and some other portions of the second connector **120** (e.g., the lower case, the supporting case, or the second terminal receiver) may be fixed to the supporting plate **3** or the first connector **110** arranged on the top side of the other air purifier.

[0129] The driving mechanism **80** may force the some other portion of the second connector **120** fixed to the supporting plate **3** or the other air purifier to be rotated. Hence, the main body **10** of the air purifier **1** may be rotated relative to the supporting plate **3** or the other air purifier.

[0130] For example, the second terminal receiver **123** of the second connector **120** may be coupled to the supporting plate **3** or the first terminal receiver **113** of the first connector **110** arranged at the other air purifier to limit rotational movement. For example, a plurality of teeth may be formed on the inner surface of the receiving space **123a** of the second terminal receiver **123** to protrude from the inner surface, and a plurality of teeth may be formed on the outer surface of the first terminal receiver **113** to protrude from the outer surface. Hence, rotation of the second terminal receiver **123** relative to the first terminal receiver **113** may be limited.

[0131] The driving mechanism **80** may force the second terminal receiver **123** of the second connector **120** to be rotated. The second terminal receiver **123** forced to rotate may be rotated along with the first terminal receiver **113** of the first connector **110** relative to the main body **10**. In this

case, as the supporting plate **3** or the first connector **110** arranged in the other air purifier is stationary, the main body **10** may be rotated along with the second terminal receiver **123**.

[0132] In another example, the lower case **121** of the second connector **120** may be coupled to the supporting plate **3** or the first terminal receiver **113** of the first connector **110** arranged at the other air purifier to limit rotational movement.

[0133] The driving mechanism **80** may force the lower case **121** of the second connector **120** to be rotated, and the lower case **121** may be rotated along with the first terminal receiver **113** of the first connector **110** relative to the main body **10**.

[0134] The driving mechanism **80** may include, for example as shown in FIG. **11**, a second motor **81** for causing rotation to rotate the main body **10** and a power transfer mechanism **83** for transferring the rotation of the second motor **81** to the second connector **120**.

[0135] The power transfer mechanism **82** may include, for example, a first pulley **83** connected to a rotation shaft of the second motor **81**, a second pulley **84** connected to a portion of the second connector **120**, and a belt **85** for conveying power between the first pulley **83** and the second pulley **84**.

[0136] The second motor **81** may receive power from a driving circuit and rotate in response to the received power. The rotation shaft of the second motor **81** may be connected to the first pulley **83**, and the rotation of the second motor **81** may be transferred to the first pulley **83** through the rotation axis.

[0137] The first pulley **83** may receive the rotation from the rotation axis of the second motor **81**, and pass the received rotation to the second pulley **84** through the belt **85**.

[0138] The second pulley **84** may be coupled to, for example, the second terminal receiver **123**, the lower case **121**, or the supporting case **124** of the second connector **120**. The second pulley **84** may receive the rotation from the first pulley **83** through the belt **85**, and pass the received rotation to the second terminal receiver **123**, the lower case **121**, or the supporting case **124** of the second connector **120**.

[0139] The power transfer mechanism **82** is not, however, limited to the pulley-belt shown in FIG. **11**. For example, the power transfer mechanism **82** may include one or two or more gears.

Alternatively, the power transfer mechanism **82** may be omitted. Specifically, the rotation shaft of the second motor **81** may be directly connected to the second terminal receiver **123**, the lower case **121**, or the supporting case **124** of the second connector **120**, or the second motor **81** may be integrated in the second connector **120**.

[0140] In this way, the air purifier **1** may include the second connector **120** installed on the cabinet bottom side **17**, and may be mechanically or electrically connected to the supporting plate **3** through the second connector **120**. Furthermore, the air purifier **1** may include the driving mechanism **80** for rotating the main body **10**, and the driving mechanism **80** may rotate the main body **10** relative to the second connector **120** by forcing a portion of the second connector **120** to be rotated.

[0141] FIG. **12** illustrates an air purifier arranged on another air purifier, according to an embodiment. FIG. **13** illustrates an air purifier rotated on another air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0142] As shown in FIG. **12**, the air purifier **1** may be detachably installed on another air purifier **4**.

[0143] The other air purifier **4** may support and/or fix the air purifier **1**.

[0144] Furthermore, the other air purifier **4** may supply power to the air purifier **1**. For example, the other air purifier **4** may include a power line for receiving power from an external power source and an adapter for transforming the power received from the external power source.

[0145] As described above, the first connector **110** that may mechanically or electrically connect the air purifier **1** to another device placed on the air purifier **1** may be arranged on the top of the air purifier **1**. Furthermore, the second connector **120** that may mechanically and/or electrically connect the air purifier **1** to another device placed under the air purifier **1** may be arranged on the

bottom of the air purifier **1**.

[0146] Similar to the air purifier **1**, the other air purifier **4** may include the first connector **110** arranged on its top. The first connector **110** of the other air purifier **4** may be identical to the first connector **110** of the air purifier **1**.

[0147] Furthermore, the other air purifier **4** may include the second connector **120** arranged on its bottom. The second connector **120** of the other air purifier **4** may be identical to the second connector **120** of the air purifier **1**.

[0148] The air purifier **1** placed on the top of the other air purifier **4** may be mechanically and/or electrically connected to the other air purifier **4** through the second connector **120**. The air purifier **1** may receive power from the other air purifier **4** through the second connector **120** or may supply power to the other air purifier **4** through the second connector **120**.

[0149] Although not shown in the drawings, the air purifier **1** may be placed underneath the other air purifier **4**. In this case, the air purifier **1** may be mechanically and/or electrically connected to the other air purifier **4** through the first connector **110**.

[0150] The air purifier **1** placed on the top of the other air purifier **4** may be rotated relative to the other air purifier **4**.

[0151] As described above, the air purifier **1** may include the driving mechanism **80** for rotating the main body **10**.

[0152] For example, the driving mechanism **80** of the air purifier **1** may rotate the main body **10** of the air purifier **1** relative to the other air purifier **4**, as shown in FIG. **13**. Hence, a direction that the front panel **20** of the air purifier **1** faces may be different from a direction that the front panel of the other air purifier **4** faces. In other words, the air purifier **1** may discharge purified air in a different direction from the other air purifier **4**.

[0153] FIG. **14** illustrates a solar cell and a battery included in an air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0154] As shown in FIG. **14**, a charging circuit **90** may be arranged between the solar cell **60** and the battery **70**.

[0155] The charging circuit **90** may include a first direct current (DC) to DC converter (DC-DC converter) **91**, a voltage sensor **92**, a temperature sensor **93**, or a conversion controller **94**.

[0156] The first DC-DC converter **91** may convert a voltage of the power output from the solar cell **60** to a first voltage of the battery **70**, e.g., 20 V or 24 V. The solar cell **60** may output a voltage that varies depending on an amount of incident light. For example, the voltage output by the solar cell **60** may increase the larger the amount of incident light, and the voltage output by the solar cell **60** may decrease the smaller the amount of incident light. Meanwhile, an output voltage of the battery **70** may vary depending on capacity of the battery **70** and a charge rate of the battery **70**, but may follow the first voltage.

[0157] The first DC-DC converter **91** may convert the varying output voltage of the solar cell **60** to a constant first voltage. The output voltage of the solar cell **60** may be higher or lower than the first voltage, and the first DC-DC converter **91** may include a voltage conversion circuit for increasing or decreasing the input voltage. For example, the first DC-DC converter **91** may include a buck-boost converter for outputting an increased or reduced voltage.

[0158] The voltage sensor **92** may detect a voltage of the power output from the solar cell **60**, and provide an electric signal that represents the output voltage of the solar cell **60**, e.g., a voltage signal or a current signal, to the conversion controller **94**. For example, the voltage sensor **92** may include a voltage divider, and provide an output voltage of the voltage divider to the conversion controller **94**.

[0159] The temperature sensor **93** may detect the temperature of the battery **70**, and provide an electric signal that represents the temperature of the battery **70** to the conversion controller **94**. For example, the temperature sensor **93** may include a voltage divider including a thermistor, and provide an output voltage of the voltage divider to the conversion controller **94**.

[0160] The conversion controller **94** may control an operation of the first DC-DC converter **91** based on the output signal of the voltage sensor **92** or the output signal of the temperature sensor **93**.

[0161] For example, the conversion controller **94** may control the first DC-DC converter **91** to reduce the input voltage based on a magnitude of the output signal of the voltage sensor **92** being greater than a reference value that represents a first voltage. In other words, when the output voltage of the solar cell **60** is greater than the first voltage, the conversion controller **94** may control the first DC-DC converter **91** to output a reduced voltage.

[0162] Furthermore, the conversion controller **94** may control the first DC-DC converter **91** to increase the input voltage based on a magnitude of the output signal of the voltage sensor **92** being smaller than the reference value that represents the first voltage. In other words, when the output voltage of the solar cell **60** is smaller than the first voltage, the conversion controller **94** may control the first DC-DC converter **91** to output an increased voltage.

[0163] For example, the conversion controller **94** may stop operation of the first DC-DC converter **91** based on a magnitude of the output signal of the temperature sensor **93** being greater than a reference value that represents a reference temperature. In other words, when the battery **70** is overheated, the conversion controller **94** may stop operation of the first DC-DC converter **91**.

[0164] In this way, the battery **70** may be charged with power having almost a constant voltage supplied from the solar cell **60**.

[0165] FIG. **15** illustrates a configuration of an air purifier, according to an embodiment. FIG. **16** illustrates a power circuit included in an air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0166] As shown in FIG. **15**, the air purifier **1** may include a control panel **210**, a light sensor **220**, a contamination sensor **230**, a terminal sensor **240**, the first motor **52**, a first driving circuit **250**, the second motor **81**, a second driving circuit **260**, a communication module **270**, a power circuit **280**, or a controller **290**.

[0167] The control panel **210** may provide the user with a user interface to interact with the user. For example, the control panel **210** may be arranged on the top of the main body **10** or in an upper portion of the front panel **20**.

[0168] The control panel **210** may include an input button **211** or a display **212**.

[0169] The input button **211** may obtain the user's input related to an operation of the air purifier **1**. For example, the input button **211** may obtain a wind volume or wind velocity of the air discharged by the air purifier **1**.

[0170] The input button **211** may include a tact switch, a push switch, a slide switch, a toggle switch, a micro switch, or a touch switch.

[0171] The display **212** may display operation information of the air purifier **1**. Furthermore, the display **212** may display the user's input obtained in association with an operation of the air purifier **1**. For example, the input button **212** may display a wind volume or wind velocity of the air discharged by the air purifier **1**.

[0172] The display **212** may include, for example, a liquid crystal display (LCD) panel, a light emitting diode (LED) panel, or the like.

[0173] The light sensor **220** may collect information regarding an incidence direction of light from the sun. For example, the light sensor **220** may be arranged on a side of the main body **10** or on the rear side of the main body **10**.

[0174] The light sensor **220** may include, for example, a first light sensor **221** and a second light sensor **222**.

[0175] The first light sensor **221** and the second light sensor **222** may each receive light and output an electric signal (e.g., a voltage signal or a current signal) corresponding to an intensity of the received light. For example, each of the first light sensor **221** and the second light sensor **222** may include a photo diode or a photo resistor. The photo diode may output a voltage or current depending on an intensity of the received light. Furthermore, the photo resistor may indicate an

electric resistance value depending on the intensity of the received light.

[0176] The controller **290** may identify the intensity of light that enters the first light sensor **221** based on an output of the first light sensor **221**, and the intensity of light that enters the second light sensor **222** based on an output of the second light sensor **222**.

[0177] The first light sensor **221** and the second light sensor **222** may be arranged on different planes or in different positions on the same plane.

[0178] For example, the first light sensor **221** may be arranged on the left side of the main body **10** and the second light sensor **222** may be arranged on the right side of the main body **10**. The first light sensor **221** may output an electric signal that represents an intensity of light entering the left side of the main body **10**. The second light sensor **222** may output an electric signal that represents an intensity of light entering the right side of the main body **10**.

[0179] The controller **290** may identify whether the rear panel **30** of the air purifier **1**, on which the solar cell **60** is installed, faces the sun, based on the output of the first light sensor **221** and the output of the second light sensor **222**. For example, the controller **290** may identify that the rear panel **30** of the air purifier **1** faces the sun, based on the output of the first light sensor **221** and the output of the second light sensor **222** being almost the same. Furthermore, the controller **290** may identify that the rear panel **30** of the air purifier **1** is not facing the sun, based on the output of the first light sensor **221** and the output of the second light sensor **222** being different each other.

[0180] In another example, the first light sensor **221** may be arranged on the rear-left side, and the second light sensor **222** may be arranged on the rear-right side of the main body **10**. The first light sensor **221** may output an electric signal that represents an intensity of light entering the rear-left side of the main body **10**. The second light sensor **222** may output an electric signal that represents an intensity of light entering the rear-right side of the main body **10**.

[0181] The controller **290** may identify whether the rear panel **30** of the air purifier **1**, on which the solar cell **60** is installed, faces the sun, based on the output of the first light sensor **221** and the output of the second light sensor **222**. For example, the controller **290** may identify that the rear panel **30** of the air purifier **1** faces the sun, based on the average of the output of the first light sensor **221** and the output of the second light sensor **222** being equal to or greater than a first reference value. Furthermore, the controller **290** may identify that the rear side of the air purifier **1** is shaded, based on the difference between the output of the first light sensor **221** and the output of the second light sensor **222** being equal to or greater than a second reference value.

[0182] The contamination sensor **230** may collect information about contaminants contained in the air in the space to be purified. For example, the contamination sensor **230** may collect information about a density of particles in the air that cause odor (hereinafter, called a 'gas') and/or information about a density of dust.

[0183] The contamination sensor **230** may include a gas sensor **231** or a dust sensor.

[0184] The gas sensor **231** may measure a density of the gas contained in the air and output an electric signal that represents the density of the gas. For example, the gas sensor **231** may use a change in electrical conductivity of a semiconductor device, which occurs when the gas is captured on the surface of the semiconductor, to detect the gas in the air or measure a density of the gas in the air.

[0185] The controller **290** may identify the density of the gas contained in the air in the space to be purified based on the output of the gas sensor **231**.

[0186] The dust sensor **232** may measure a temperature of the dust contained in the air, and output an electric signal that represents the density of the dust. For example, the dust sensor **232** may use the scattering of light due to dust contained in the air to detect the dust in the air or measure a density of the dust in the air. The dust sensor **232** may include a light source for emitting light, and a light sensor arranged at a location out of a path of the light emitted from the light source. The dust sensor **232** may output an electric signal that represents an intensity of light received by the light sensor.

[0187] The controller **290** may identify the density of dust contained in the air in the space to be purified based on the output of the dust sensor **232**.

[0188] The terminal sensor **240** may include, for example, a first terminal sensor **241** and a second terminal sensor **242**.

[0189] The first terminal sensor **241** may detect whether the first connector **110** is connected to another device (e.g., the solar panel or another air purifier), and output an electric signal that represents whether the first connector **110** is connected to the other device. For example, the first terminal sensor **241** may include a micro switch. The micro switch may output a high-voltage signal when the first connector **110** is connected to the other device and a low-voltage signal when the first connector **110** is not connected to the other device.

[0190] The second terminal sensor **242** may detect whether the second connector **120** is connected to another device (e.g., the supporting plate or another air purifier), and output an electric signal that represents whether the second connector **120** is connected to the other device. For example, the second terminal sensor **242** may include a micro switch.

[0191] The first motor **52** may rotate the fan wings **51**. The first motor **52** may suck in outside air through the inlet **12** and discharge purified air through the outlet **11** by rotating the fan wings **51**.

[0192] A wind volume or wind velocity of the air purifier **1** may depend on the rotational speed of the first motor **52**. The wind volume or wind velocity of the air purifier **1** may increase the higher the rotational speed of the first motor **52**. Furthermore, the wind volume or wind velocity of the air purifier **1** may decrease the lower the rotational speed of the first motor **52**.

[0193] The first driving circuit **250** may supply driving power to the first motor **52** for rotation. The first driving circuit **250** may control the driving power to be supplied to the first motor **52** based on a control signal of the controller **290**. The first driving circuit **250** may increase the driving power to be supplied to the first motor **52** to increase the rotational speed of the first motor **52**.

Furthermore, the first driving circuit **250** may reduce the driving current to be applied to the first motor **52** to reduce the rotational speed of the first motor **52**. For example, the first driving circuit **250** may receive a pulse width modulation (PWM) signal from the controller **290**, and supply PWM driving power to the first motor **52**.

[0194] The second motor **81** may rotationally move the main body **10** of the air purifier **1**. The second motor **81** may rotate a fixed portion of the second connector **120** through the driving mechanism **80**, and accordingly rotate the main body **10** of the air purifier **1**.

[0195] The second driving circuit **260** may supply driving power to the second motor **81** for rotation. The second driving circuit **260** may control the driving power to be supplied to the second motor **81** based on a control signal of the controller **290**. The second driving circuit **260** may supply positive power to the second motor **81** to rotate the second motor **81** in a first direction, or supply negative power to the second motor **81** to rotate the second motor **81** in a second direction.

Furthermore, the second driving circuit **260** may supply pulses to a plurality of terminals of the second motor **81** in a first sequence to rotate the second motor **81** in the first direction. Moreover, the second driving circuit **260** may supply pulses to the plurality of terminals in a second sequence to rotate the second motor **81** in the second direction.

[0196] The communication module **270** may include a communication circuit for exchanging data directly with the other air purifier **4** or a communication circuit for exchanging data with the other air purifier **4** through a service server.

[0197] The communication module **270** may include a wired communication module **271** for exchanging data with the other air purifier **4** wiredly or a wireless communication module **272** for exchanging data with the other air purifier **4** wirelessly.

[0198] The wired communication module **271** may access, for example, a wired communication network and communicate with the other air purifier **4** over the wired communication network. The wired communication module **271** may access the wired communication network through Ethernet, the IEEE 802.3 technology standard, and transmit or receive data to or from the other air purifier **4**.

via a server over the wired communication network.

[0199] Furthermore, the wired communication module **271** may communicate directly with the other air purifier **4** through a communication line connected to the other air purifier **4**.

[0200] The wireless communication module **272** may communicate wirelessly with e.g., a base station or an access point (AP), and access the wired communication network via the base station or the AP. The wireless communication module **272** may communicate with the other air purifier **4** connected to the wired communication network via the base station or the AP. For example, the wireless communication module **272** may use Wi-Fi, the IEEE 802.11 technology standard, to communicate with an AP, or use code divisional multiple access (CDMA), wideband code division multiple access (WCDMA), Global Systems for Mobile communications (GSM), Long Term Evolution (LTE), WiBro, etc., to communicate with a base station. The wireless communication module **272** may also transmit or receive data to or from the other air purifier **4** via a service server over the wired communication network.

[0201] Furthermore, the wireless communication module **272** may wirelessly communicate directly with the other air purifier **4**. For example, the wireless communication module **272** may use Wireless Fidelity (Wi-Fi), Bluetooth™, which is the IEEE 802.15.1 technology standard, ZigBee™, which is the IEEE 802.15.4 technology standard, etc., to wirelessly transmit or receive data directly to or from the other air purifier **4**.

[0202] The power circuit **280** may supply power to the control panel **210**, the light sensor **220**, the contamination sensor **230**, the first motor **52**, the first driving circuit **250**, the second motor **81**, the second driving circuit **260**, the communication module **270** or the controller **290**.

[0203] The power circuit **280** may receive power from at least one of a plurality of power sources, and distribute the received power to the respective components included in the air purifier **1**. The plurality of power sources may include, for example, the adapter connected to an external power source and detachably connected to the air purifier **1**, the battery **70** connected to the solar cell **60** and storing power produced by the solar cell **60**, the first power terminal **112** that may receive power from another device (e.g., the solar panel) arranged on top of the air purifier **1**, or the second power terminal **122** that may receive power from another device (e.g., the supporting plate) arranged underneath the air purifier **1**.

[0204] The power circuit **280** may receive power from the adapter **130** connected to the external power source, the battery **70** connected to the solar cell **60**, the first power terminal **112** connected to the other air purifier, or the second power terminal **122** connected to the other air purifier.

[0205] The power circuit **280** may include, for example, a power switch **280a** for receiving power from one of the adapter **130**, the battery **70**, the first power terminal **112** or the second power terminal **122**, and a voltage converter **280b** for converting a voltage of the received power.

[0206] The power switch **280a** may include, for example, a first switch **281** connected to the adapter **130**, a second switch **282** connected to the battery **70**, a third switch **283** connected to the first power terminal **112**, a fourth switch **284** connected to the second power terminal **122**, or a fifth switch **285** connected to the voltage converter **280b**.

[0207] The power switch **280a** may close (turn on) at least one of the first switch **281**, the second switch **282**, the third switch **283**, or the fourth switch **284** in response to a control signal of the controller **290**. For example, when the adapter **130** is decoupled from the main body **10**, the power switch **280a** may open (turn off) the first switch **281**. When the adapter **130** is coupled to the main body **10** and the charge rate of the battery **70** is lower than a threshold, the power switch **280a** may close (turn on) the first switch **281** and open (turn off) the second switch **282**. Furthermore, when the air purifier **1** is connected to another device on the top or bottom, the power switch **280a** may close (turn on) the third switch **283** or the fourth switch **284**.

[0208] The power switch **280a** may close (turn on) the fifth switch **285** for operation of the air purifier **1**.

[0209] The power switch **280a** may include a metal-oxide-semiconductor field effect transistor

(MOSFET), a bipolar junction transistor (BJT) or an insulated gate bipolar transistor (IGBT).

Furthermore, the power switch **280a** may include, for example, a back-to-back switch.

[0210] The voltage converter **280b** may receive power from a power source selected by the power switch **280a**. The voltage converter **280b** may convert the received power to power with various voltages.

[0211] Components included in the air purifier **1** may have different operation voltages.

Furthermore, the power source to supply power to the air purifier **1** is able to output different voltages. For example, the adapter **130** or the battery **70** may output a first voltage, e.g., 20 V or 24 V. A second voltage, e.g., 3.3 V or 5 V, may be applied to the controller **290** including a digital logic circuit or the control panel **210**. Furthermore, a third voltage, e.g., 12 V or 15 V, may be applied to the first motor **52** or the second motor **81**.

[0212] The voltage converter **280b** may convert the voltage of power received from the power source, and provide the components included in the air purifier **1** with power having the converted voltage.

[0213] The voltage converter **280b** may include a second DC-DC converter **286** for converting e.g., the first voltage to the second voltage, and a third DC-DC converter **287** for converting e.g., the first voltage to the third voltage.

[0214] The second voltage may be lower than the first voltage output by the power source, and the second DC-DC converter **286** may include a voltage conversion circuit for reducing the input voltage. For example, the second DC-DC converter **286** may include a buck converter for outputting a reduced voltage and a conversion controller for controlling the buck converter.

[0215] The third voltage may also be lower than the first voltage, and the third DC-DC converter **287** may also include a voltage conversion circuit for reducing the input voltage. For example, the third DC-DC converter **287** may include a buck converter and a conversion controller.

[0216] The controller **290** may be electrically connected to the control panel **210**, the light sensor **220**, the contamination sensor **230**, the first driving circuit **250**, the second driving circuit **260**, or the communication module **270**. The controller **290** may process the output signal received from the light sensor **220** or the contamination sensor **230**, and provide a control signal to the first driving circuit **250** or the second driving circuit **250**. Furthermore, the controller **290** may receive a communication signal from the communication module **270** and provide the communication signal.

[0217] The controller **290** may include a processor **291** for generating a control signal to control operation of the air purifier **1**, and a memory **292** for memorizing and/or storing a program and data for generating the control signal. The processor **291** and the memory **292** may be implemented with separate semiconductor devices or in a single semiconductor device.

[0218] The processor **291** may process data and/or a signal based on the program memorized or stored in the memory **292**, and provide a control signal to each component of the air purifier **1** based on the processing result.

[0219] For example, the processor **291** may provide a control signal to the display **212** to display operation information in response to a user input through the input button **211**. The processor **291** may provide a control signal to the first driving circuit **250** to control rotational speed of the first motor **52** in response to a user input through the input button **211**. The processor **291** may provide a control signal to the first driving circuit **250** to control rotation of the first motor **52** based on an output of the contamination sensor **230**. The processor **291** may provide a control signal to the second driving circuit **260** to control rotation of the second motor **81** based on an output of the light sensor **220**.

[0220] The processor **291** may obtain an electric signal that represents an input or output current and an output voltage of the battery **70** from a battery sensor arranged in the battery **70**, and identify a charge rate of the battery **70** based on the input or output current and the output voltage of the battery **70**.

[0221] The processor **291** may identify whether the first connector **110** is connected to the solar

panel **2** or another air purifier based on the output signal of the first terminal sensor **241**. In other words, the processor **291** may identify whether the first power terminal **112** is connected to another device. Furthermore, the processor **291** may identify whether the second connector **120** is connected to the supporting plate **3** or another air purifier based on the output signal of the second terminal sensor **242**. In other words, the processor **291** may identify whether the second power terminal **122** is connected to another device.

[0222] The processor **291** may identify whether the adapter **130** is connected to the main body **10**.

[0223] The processor **291** may control the power switch **280a** based on the charge rate of the battery **70**, whether the first power terminal **112** is connected to the solar panel **2** or another air purifier, whether the second power terminal **122** is connected to the supporting plate **3** or another air purifier, or whether the adapter **130** is connected to the main body **10**.

[0224] The memory **292** may memorize/store a program and data for controlling a purifying operation of the air purifier **1**.

[0225] The memory **292** may include a non-volatile memory or a volatile memory.

[0226] The non-volatile memory may store e.g., the program and/or data electrically, magnetically, or optically. The non-volatile memory may include, for example, a read-only memory (ROM) for storing data for a long period, or a flash memory. Furthermore, the non-volatile memory may include a solid state drive (SSD), a hard disc drive (HDD), an optical disc drive (ODD), or the like.

[0227] The volatile memory may load e.g., the program and/or data from the non-volatile memory and electrically store the program and/or data. The volatile memory may include, for example, a static random access memory (SRAM), a dynamic RAM (DRAM), or the like.

[0228] The memory **292** may store/memorize a program and data such as an operating system (OS), middleware and application, and the like, and provide the program and data to the processor **291** in response to a request from the processor **291**.

[0229] The memory **292** may include a memory device, or multiple memory devices.

[0230] In this way, the controller **290** may control the posture of the air purifier **1** based on a light incidence direction. Furthermore, the controller **290** may control power application to each component of the air purifier **1** based on whether the adapter **130** is connected or a charge rate of the battery **70**.

[0231] FIG. **17** illustrates an example of an operation of an air purifier according to an embodiment. FIG. **18** illustrates light incidence to an air purifier according to an embodiment. FIG. **19** illustrates rotation of an air purifier according to an embodiment.

[0232] In connection with FIGS. **17**, **18** and **19**, an operation **1000** in which the air purifier **1** controls the posture of the main body **10** will be described.

[0233] The air purifier **1** may produce power using the solar cell **60**, in **1010**.

[0234] For example, the solar cell **60** may convert solar energy to electric energy. In other words, the solar cell **60** may produce power.

[0235] The battery **70** may convert the electrical energy obtained from the solar cell **60** to chemical energy and store the chemical energy. In other words, the battery **70** may store the power produced by the solar cell **60**.

[0236] The air purifier **1** may identify whether the second connector **120** is connected to another device, in **1020**. When no other device is connected to the second connector **120** (no of **1020**), the air purifier **1** may keep the posture of the main body **10**, in **1070**.

[0237] For example, the controller **290** may identify whether the second connector **120** is connected to the supporting plate **3** or another air purifier based on the output signal of the second terminal sensor **242**.

[0238] When the second connector **120** is not connected to the supporting plate **3** or the other air purifier, the main body **10** of the air purifier **1** may not be rotated around the second connector **120**. Hence, the air purifier **1** may keep the current posture without rotation.

[0239] When the other device is connected to the second connector **120** (yes of **1020**), the air

purifier **1** may identify whether the magnitude of a first output signal of the first light sensor **221** is larger than the sum of the magnitude of a second output signal of the second light sensor **222** and an allowable error, in **1030**.

[0240] For example, the first light sensor **221** may be arranged on the left side of the main body **10** and may output an electric signal corresponding to an intensity of light entering the left side of the main body **10**. As the intensity of light entering the left side increases, the magnitude of an output signal of the first light sensor **221** may increase, and as the intensity of light entering the left side decreases, the magnitude of an output signal of the first light sensor **221** may decrease.

[0241] Furthermore, the second light sensor **222** may be arranged on the right side of the main body **10** and may output an electric signal corresponding to an intensity of light entering the right side of the main body **10**. As the intensity of light entering the right side increases, the magnitude of an output signal of the second light sensor **222** may increase, and as the intensity of light entering the right side decreases, the magnitude of an output signal of the second light sensor **222** may decrease.

[0242] The controller **290** may compare the magnitude of the first output signal with the sum of the magnitude of the second output signal and the allowable error, to identify a light incidence direction. The allowable error may indicate an allowable difference between the magnitude of the first output signal and the magnitude of the second output signal. The allowable error may set experimentally or empirically.

[0243] When the magnitude of the first output signal is larger than the sum of the magnitude of the second output signal and the allowable error (yes of **1030**), the air purifier **1** may rotate the main body **10** so that the rear panel **30** is rotated to a direction in which the first light sensor **221** is positioned, in **1040**.

[0244] For example, the controller **290** may identify entrance of the light into a side where the first light sensor **221** is arranged, based on the magnitude of the first output signal being larger than the sum of the magnitude of the second output signal and the allowable error.

[0245] As shown in FIG. **18**, the light may enter the rear-left side of the main body **10**. Hence, the magnitude of the first output signal of the first light sensor **221** may be larger than the magnitude of the second output signal by the allowable error or more. Accordingly, efficiency of solar power of the solar cell **60** arranged on the rear panel **30** may be reduced.

[0246] The controller **290** may rotate the main body **10** to increase the efficiency of the solar power of the solar cell **60** arranged on the rear panel **30**. The controller **290** may rotate the main body **10** such that the rear panel **30** on which the solar cell **60** is installed faces a light incidence direction. In other words, the controller **290** may rotate the main body **10** such that the rear panel **30** is rotated to the left direction of the main body **10** in which the first light sensor **221** is installed. The controller **290** may rotate the main body **10** such that the rear panel **30** faces a direction (rear-left direction) in which the first light sensor **221** is positioned.

[0247] The controller **290** may control the second driving circuit **260** such that the second motor **81** rotates the main body **10**. For example, as shown in FIG. **19**, the controller **290** may control the second driving circuit **260** such that the second motor **81** rotates the main body **10** counterclockwise.

[0248] When the magnitude of the first output signal is not larger than the sum of the magnitude of the second output signal and the allowable error (no of **1030**), the air purifier **1** may identify whether the magnitude of a second output signal of the second light sensor **222** is larger than the sum of the magnitude of the first output signal of the first light sensor **221** and an allowable error, in **1050**.

[0249] For example, the controller **290** may compare the magnitude of the second output signal with the sum of the magnitude of the first output signal and the allowable error, to identify a light incidence direction.

[0250] When the magnitude of the second output signal is larger than the sum of the magnitude of

the first output signal and the allowable error (yes of **1050**), the air purifier **1** may rotate the main body **10** so that the rear panel **30** is rotated to a direction in which the second light sensor **222** is positioned, in **1060**.

[0251] For example, the controller **290** may identify entrance of the light into a side where the second light sensor **222** is arranged, based on the magnitude of the second output signal being larger than the sum of the magnitude of the first output signal and the allowable error.

[0252] The controller **290** may rotate the main body **10** so that the rear panel **30** faces the light incidence direction, to increase the efficiency of the solar power of the solar cell **60** arranged on the rear panel **30**. In other words, the controller **290** may rotate the main body **10** such that the rear panel **30** faces a direction (rear-left direction) in which the second light sensor **222** is positioned.

[0253] When the magnitude of the second output signal is not larger than the sum of the magnitude of the first output signal and the allowable error (no of **1050**), the air purifier **1** may keep the current posture of the main body **10**, in **1070**.

[0254] For example, the controller **290** may control the second driving circuit **260** to keep the current posture of the main body **10** without rotation, based on the magnitude of the first output signal being equal to the magnitude of the second output signal. The controller **290** may control the second driving circuit **260** to keep the current posture of the main body **10** without rotation, based on the magnitude of the first output signal being less than the magnitude of the second output signal by the allowable error.

[0255] In this way, the air purifier **1** may rotate the main body **10** so that the solar cell **60** faces a light incidence direction. Hence, the air purifier **1** may increase efficiency of solar power of the solar cell **60**.

[0256] FIG. **20** illustrates an operation of an air purifier according to an embodiment. FIG. **21** illustrates an air purifier receiving power from a battery, according to an embodiment. FIG. **22** illustrates an air purifier receiving power from an adapter, according to an embodiment.

[0257] In connection with FIGS. **20**, **21** and **22**, an operation **1100** in which the air purifier **1** controls power reception will be described.

[0258] The air purifier **1** may measure a density of contaminants in the air, in **1110**.

[0259] For example, the contamination sensor **230** may measure the density of the contaminants in the air in the space to be purified. The gas sensor **231** may output an electric signal corresponding to the density of gas in the space to be purified. Furthermore, the dust sensor **232** may output an electric signal corresponding to a density of dust in the space to be purified.

[0260] The controller **290** may identify the density of gas in the air based on the output signal of the gas sensor **231** and identify the density of dust in the air based on the output signal of the dust sensor **232**.

[0261] The air purifier **1** may identify whether the density of the measured contaminants is equal to or less than a reference density, in **1120**.

[0262] For example, the controller **290** may compare the density of gas based on the output signal of the gas sensor **231** with the reference density of gas. The reference density of gas may represent a density of gas to increase a wind volume (or wind velocity) of the air purifier **1** to a next level (e.g., from a first wind volume to a second wind volume).

[0263] The controller **290** may compare a density of dust based on the output signal of the dust sensor **232** with a reference density of dust. The reference density of dust may represent a density of dust to increase a wind volume (or wind velocity) of the air purifier **1** to a next level (e.g., from a first wind volume to a second wind volume).

[0264] When the measured density of gas is equal to or less than the reference density of gas and the measured density of dust is equal to or less than the reference density of dust, the controller **290** may identify that the measured density of the contaminants is equal to or less than the reference density.

[0265] When the measured density of the contaminants is equal to or less than the reference density

(yes of **1120**), the air purifier **1** may operate with a first wind volume (or first wind velocity), in **1130**.

[0266] For example, the controller **290** may rotate the first motor **52** at a first speed so that the air purifier **1** is operated with the first wind volume (or first wind velocity) based on the measured density of gas is equal to or less than the reference density of gas and the measured density of dust is equal to or less than the reference density of dust. The controller **290** may control the first driving circuit **250** such that the first motor **52** is rotated at a first speed.

[0267] The power consumed by the air purifier **1** operated with the first wind volume may be lower than power produced by the solar cell **60**. In other words, the air purifier **1** may be operated with the first wind volume by consuming the power produced by the solar cell **60** without consuming power charged in the battery **70**.

[0268] The air purifier **1** may receive the power from the battery **70**, in **1140**.

[0269] For example, the controller **290** may receive the power from the battery **70** without receiving power from the adapter **130**. As shown in FIG. **21**, the controller **290** may control the power circuit **280** to close (turn on) the second switch **282** and the fifth switch **285** and open (turn off) the first switch **281**, the third switch **283** and the fourth switch **284**.

[0270] Hence, the air purifier **1** may consume only the power produced by the solar cell **60** without consuming power from an external power source while being operated with the first wind volume.

[0271] When the measured density of the contaminants is not equal to or less than the reference density (no of **1120**), the air purifier **1** may operate with a second wind volume (or second wind velocity) larger than the first wind volume (or first wind velocity), in **1150**.

[0272] For example, the air purifier **1** may increase the wind volume (or wind velocity) of the purified air the higher the density of the contaminants.

[0273] Specifically, the controller **290** may rotate the first motor **52** at the second speed so that the air purifier **1** is operated with the second wind volume (or second wind velocity) larger than the first wind volume based on the measured density of gas being larger than the reference density of gas or the measured density of dust being larger than the reference density of dust. The controller **290** may control the first driving circuit **250** such that the first motor **52** is rotated at the second speed.

[0274] The power consumed by the air purifier **2** operated with the second wind volume may be larger than power produced by the solar cell **60**. In other words, the air purifier **1** may be operated with the second wind volume by consuming the power charged in the battery **70** and the power produced by the solar cell **60**. Hence, when the air purifier **1** is operated with the second wind volume, the charge rate of the battery **70** may decrease.

[0275] The air purifier **1** may identify whether the charge rate of the battery **70** is equal to or less than a reference charge rate, in **1160**.

[0276] For example, the controller **290** may receive an electric signal that represents an input or output current and/or an output voltage of the battery **70** from the battery sensor. The controller **290** may identify the charge rate of the battery **70** based on an input or output current and/or an output voltage of the battery **70**. The controller **290** may compare the charge rate of the battery **70** with the reference charge rate.

[0277] The reference charge rate may represent a charge rate of the battery **70** with which the air purifier **1** receiving the power from the battery **70** is able to operate with the second wind volume for a reference period. In other words, when the charge rate of the battery **70** is lower than the reference charge rate, the air purifier **1** may be operated with the second wind volume for a shorter period than the reference period. The reference charge rate may be set experimentally or empirically.

[0278] In another example, the controller **290** may compare the output voltage of the battery **70** with a reference voltage to identify whether the charge rate of the battery **70** is equal to or less than the reference charge rate. The reference voltage of the battery **70** may correspond to the reference

charge rate of the battery **70**.

[0279] When the charge rate of the battery **70** is not equal to or less than the reference charge rate (no of **1160**), the air purifier **1** may receive power from the battery **70**, in **1140**.

[0280] For example, as the air purifier **1** is operated with the second wind volume for more than a reference period, the controller **290** may consume only the power produced by the solar cell **60** without consuming power from an external power source.

[0281] When the charge rate of the battery **70** is equal to or less than the reference charge rate (yes of **1160**), the air purifier **1** may receive power from the adapter **130**, in **1170**.

[0282] For example, the controller **290** may receive the power from the adapter **130** without receiving power from the battery **70**. As shown in FIG. **22**, the controller **290** may control the power circuit **280** to close (turn on) the first switch **281** and the fifth switch **285** and open (turn off) the second switch **282**, the third switch **283** and the fourth switch **284**.

[0283] Hence, the air purifier **1** may receive power from an external power source while being operated with the second wind volume, and charge the battery **70** using the power produced by the solar cell **60**.

[0284] As described above, the air purifier **1** may receive power from the battery **70** charged by the solar cell **60** based on a density of contaminants in the air being lower than the reference density. Furthermore, the air purifier **1** may receive power from the battery **70** charged by the solar cell **60** based on a density of contaminants in the air being equal to or greater than the reference density and a charge rate of the battery **70** is equal to or higher than the reference charge rate.

[0285] Hence, the air purifier **1** may reduce consumption of power from the external power source. Also, an increase of electricity bills due to constant use of the air purifier **1** may be prevented or controlled.

[0286] FIGS. **23A** and **23B** illustrate an operation of an air purifier according to an embodiment. FIG. **24** illustrates an air purifier providing power to another air purifier, according to an embodiment. FIG. **25** illustrates an air purifier receiving power from another air purifier, according to an embodiment.

[0287] In connection with FIGS. **23A**, **23B**, **24** and **25**, an operation **1200** in which the air purifier **1** transmits or receives power to or from another air purifier **4** will be described.

[0288] The air purifier **1** may identify connection of the first connector **110** to the other air purifier **4**, in **1210**.

[0289] For example, the other air purifier **4** may be placed on the top of the air purifier **1**. The first connector **110** of the air purifier **1** may be physically or electrically connected to the second connector **120** of the other air purifier **4**. Hence, the first power terminal **112** of the air purifier **1** may be electrically connected to the second power terminal **122** of the other air purifier **4**.

[0290] The controller **290** of the air purifier **1** may identify that the first connector **110** is connected to another device based on an output signal of the first terminal sensor **241**.

[0291] The controller **290** of the air purifier **1** may attempt communication with the other air purifier **4** through the communication module **270**. The controller **290** may control the communication module **270** to transmit a discovery signal (e.g., a beacon frame) to identify the other air purifier **4**.

[0292] The other air purifier **4** may transmit a response signal to the air purifier **1** in response to the discovery signal of the air purifier **1**. Based on the response signal of the other air purifier **4**, a communication channel may be established between the air purifier **1** and the other air purifier **4**.

[0293] The controller **290** of the air purifier **1** may identify that the first connector **110** is connected to the other air purifier **4** based on the communication channel being established with the other air purifier **4**. In other words, the controller **290** may identify that the first power terminal **112** is connected to the second power terminal **122** of the other air purifier **4**.

[0294] The air purifier **1** may receive information regarding power management from the other air purifier **4**.

[0295] For example, the controller **290** of the air purifier **1** may receive the information regarding the power management from the other air purifier **4** through the communication channel with the other air purifier **4**. The controller **290** may receive information about a charge rate (or an output voltage) of the battery **70** of the other air purifier **4** from the other air purifier **4**.

[0296] The controller **290** of the air purifier **1** may identify the charge rate (or the output voltage) of the battery **70** of the other air purifier **4** based on the information received from the other air purifier **4**.

[0297] The air purifier **1** may identify whether power is received from the adapter **130**, in **1230**.

[0298] For example, the controller **290** of the air purifier **1** may identify whether the air purifier **1** is connected to the adapter **130** or the air purifier **1** receives power from the adapter **130** based on information about connection with the adapter **130**.

[0299] The air purifier **1** may include a connection detection sensor (or connection detection switch) for identifying whether the adapter **130** is connected to the air purifier **1**. The controller **290** may identify whether the air purifier **1** is connected to the adapter **130** based on an output signal of the connection detection sensor.

[0300] When the air purifier **1** receives power from the adapter **130** (yes of **1230**), the air purifier **1** identifies whether the charge rate of the battery **70** of the other air purifier **4** is equal to or less than a reference charge rate, in **1240**.

[0301] For example, the controller **290** of the air purifier **1** may identify the charge rate (or the output voltage) of the battery **70** of the other air purifier **4** based on the information regarding power management received from the other air purifier **4**.

[0302] Furthermore, the controller **290** may compare the charge rate (or output voltage) of the other air purifier **4** with a reference charge rate (or reference voltage). The reference charge rate may represent a charge rate of the battery **70** with which the other air purifier **4** is able to operate with a maximum wind volume for a reference period. The reference charge rate may be set experimentally or empirically.

[0303] When the charge rate (or output voltage) of the other air purifier **4** is equal to or less than the reference charge rate (or reference voltage) (yes of **1240**), the air purifier **1** may supply power to the other air purifier **4**, in **1250**.

[0304] For example, the controller **290** of the air purifier **1** may control the power circuit **280** to supply power to the other air purifier **4**. As shown in FIG. **24**, the controller **290** may close (turn on) the first switch **281** to receive power from the adapter **130**, and close (turn on) the fifth switch **285** to supply power to the air purifier **1**. Furthermore, the controller **290** may close (turn on) the third switch **283** connected to the first power terminal **112** to supply power to the other air purifier **4**.

[0305] The power received from the adapter **130** may be supplied to the voltage converter **280b** of the other air purifier **4** through the first power terminal **112** and the second power terminal **122** of the other air purifier **4**. Optionally, the power may be supplied to the battery **70** of the other air purifier **4**. Hence, the other air purifier **4** may be operated or may charge the battery **70** with the power received from the air purifier **1**.

[0306] When the charge rate (or output voltage) of the other air purifier **4** is not equal to or less than the reference charge rate (or reference voltage) (no of **1240**), the air purifier **1** may not transmit or receive power to or from the other air purifier **4**, in **1290**.

[0307] For example, when the charge rate of the battery **70** of the other air purifier **4** is higher than the reference charge rate, it may be identified that the other air purifier **4** is able to operate with a maximum wind volume for more than a reference period. To minimize power reception from an external power source, the air purifier **1** may not supply power to the other air purifier **4** from the adapter **130**.

[0308] Although not shown in the drawings, the air purifier **1** may not supply power to the other air purifier **4** from the adapter **130** when the density of contaminants is lower than the reference

density.

[0309] When the density of contaminants detected by the contamination sensor **230** of the air purifier **1** is lower than the reference density, it may be identified that the density of the contaminants detected by the other air purifier **4** is also lower than the reference density.

Furthermore, the other air purifier **4** may not be operated with the maximum wind volume.

[0310] It may be identified that the other air purifier **4** is able to operate for more than a reference period with the power produced by the solar cell **60**. Accordingly, to minimize power reception from an external power source, the air purifier **1** may not supply power to the other air purifier **4** from the adapter **130**.

[0311] When the air purifier **1** does not receive power from the adapter **130** (no of **1230**), the air purifier **1** may identify whether a first charge rate of the battery **70** of the air purifier **1** is larger than the sum of a second charge rate of the battery **70** of the other air purifier **4** and an allowable error, in **1260**.

[0312] For example, the controller **290** of the air purifier **1** may compare the first charge rate of the air purifier **1** with the sum of the second charge rate of the other air purifier **4** and the allowable error. The allowable error may represent an allowable difference between the charge rate of the air purifier **1** and the charge rate of the other air purifier **4**. The allowable error may set experimentally or empirically.

[0313] When the first charge rate is larger than the sum of the second charge rate and the allowable error (yes of **1260**), the air purifier **1** may supply power to the other air purifier **4**, in **1250**.

[0314] For example, the controller **290** of the air purifier **1** may control the power circuit **280** to supply power to the other air purifier **4**. The controller **290** may close (turn on) the second switch **282** to receive power from the battery **70**, and close (turn on) the third switch **283** connected to the first power terminal **112** to supply power to the other air purifier **4**.

[0315] The power of the battery **70** included in the air purifier **1** may be supplied to the voltage converter **280b** of the other air purifier **4** through the first power terminal **112** and the second power terminal **122** of the other air purifier **4**. Hence, the other air purifier **4** may receive power from the air purifier **1**. Furthermore, the other air purifier **4** may charge the battery **70** by means of the solar cell **60** while receiving power from the air purifier **1**.

[0316] Accordingly, an operation time of the other air purifier **4** may increase. Furthermore, a difference between the operation time of the air purifier **1** and the operation time of the other air purifier **4** decreases, and a normal operation time of air purification system for which both the air purifier **1** and the other air purifier **4** are operated may increase.

[0317] When the first charge rate is not larger than the sum of the second charge rate and the allowable error (no of **1260**), the air purifier **1** may identify whether the second charge rate of the battery **70** of the other air purifier **4** is larger than the sum of the first charge rate of the battery **70** of the air purifier **1** and the allowable error, in **1270**.

[0318] For example, the controller **290** of the air purifier **1** may compare the second charge rate of the other air purifier **4** with the sum of the first charge rate of the air purifier **1** and the allowable error.

[0319] When the second charge rate is larger than the sum of the first charge rate and the allowable error (yes of **1270**), the air purifier **1** may receive power from the other air purifier **4**, in **1280**.

[0320] For example, the controller **290** of the air purifier **1** may control the power circuit **280** to receive power from the other air purifier **4**. As shown in FIG. 25, the controller **290** may close (turn on) the third switch **283** to receive power through the first power terminal **112**, and close (turn on) the fifth switch **285** to supply power to the air purifier **1**.

[0321] The air purifier **1** may receive power from the other air purifier **4** through the first power terminal **112**. Furthermore, the air purifier **1** may charge the battery **70** by means of the solar cell **60** while receiving power from the other air purifier **4**.

[0322] Accordingly, an operation time of the air purifier **1** may increase. Furthermore, a difference

between the operation time of the air purifier **1** and the operation time of the other air purifier **4** decreases, and a normal operation time of air purification system for which both the air purifier **1** and the other air purifier **4** are operated may increase.

[0323] When the second charge rate is not larger than the sum of the first charge rate and the allowable error (no of **1270**), the air purifier **1** may not transmit or receive power to or from the other air purifier **4**, in **1290**.

[0324] For example, when the difference between the first charge rate of the air purifier **1** and the second charge rate of the other air purifier **4** is smaller than the allowable error, it may be identified that the operation time of the air purifier **1** is almost the same as the operation time of the other air purifier **4**. Furthermore, a normal operation time of air purification system for which both the air purifier **1** and the other air purifier **4** are operated may be maximized.

[0325] To efficiently consume power, the air purifier **1** may not receive power from the other air purifier **4** nor transmit power to the other air purifier **4**.

[0326] As described above, the air purifier **1** may control transmission or reception of power between the air purifier **1** and the other air purifier **4** based on a power state of the air purifier **1** and/or a power state of the other air purifier **4**.

[0327] Hence, the air purifier **1** may supply power to the other air purifier **4**, and minimize power reception from an external power source through the adapter **130** to supply the power to the other air purifier **4**. Furthermore, the air purifier **1** may maximize a normal operation time of air purification system for which both the air purifier **1** and the other air purifier **4** are operated.

[0328] According to an embodiment, an air purifier may include a main body including an inlet and an outlet; a fan arranged in the main body; a solar cell arranged on a first side of the main body; a first light sensor arranged on a second side, which is different from the first side; a second light sensor arranged on a third side, which is different from the first and second sides; a driver arranged to rotate the main body; and a processor configured to control the fan to suck air into the main body through the inlet and discharge the air out of the main body through the outlet. The processor may control the driver to rotate the main body based on an output signal from the first light sensor and an output signal from the second light sensor.

[0329] Accordingly, power efficiency of the solar cell may be improved. Furthermore, an amount of power received by the air purifier from an external power source may be reduced.

[0330] The processor may rotate the main body so that the first side on which the solar cell is arranged faces a light incidence direction, based on a difference between the output signal of the first light sensor and the output signal of the second light sensor.

[0331] The processor may rotate the main body so that the first side is rotated to a direction in which the second side is arranged, based on a magnitude of the output signal of the first light sensor being larger than a magnitude of the output signal of the second light sensor.

[0332] By comparison between the magnitude of the output signal of the first light sensor and the magnitude of the output signal of the second light sensor, the light incidence direction may be identified and the solar cell may be forced to face the light incidence direction.

[0333] The inlet may be arranged to surround the solar cell.

[0334] This may prevent the solar cell from disturbing the flow of air through the inlet.

[0335] The air purifier may further include a battery electrically connected to the solar cell, and a power circuit configured to supply power to the fan from one of the battery and an external power source. The processor may control the power circuit to supply power to the fan from one of the battery or the external power source based on a charge rate of the battery.

[0336] It may control the power circuit to provide power to the fan from the external power source based on the density of the contaminant based on an output signal of the contamination sensor being larger than a reference density and the charge rate of the battery is less than a reference charge rate.

[0337] It may control the power circuit to provide power to the fan from the battery based on the

density of the contaminant based on an output signal of the contamination sensor being smaller than the reference density or the charge rate of the battery is larger than the reference charge rate. [0338] Hence, the air purifier may efficiently use the power of the battery without degrading air purification performance.

[0339] The air purifier may further include a first connector arranged on the top side of the main body to be connected to a first device, and a second connector arranged on the bottom side of the main body to be connected to a second device.

[0340] Hence, the air purifier may be connected to another device (e.g., a light panel, a supporting panel, or another air purifier).

[0341] The air purifier may further include a communication module for communicating the first device or the second device. The processor may receive a charge rate of the battery of the first device or the second device through the communication module.

[0342] Based on the charge rate of the battery of the first device or the second device, power may be transmitted to the first device or the second device through the first connector or the second connector.

[0343] Based on comparison between the charge rate of the battery of the first device or the second device and the charge rate of the battery of the air purifier, power may be transmitted to the first device or the second device or power may be received from the first device or the second device.

[0344] Hence, the air purifier may receive power from another device (e.g., a solar panel, a supporting panel, or another air purifier) through a connector or provide power to the other device through the connector. Furthermore, the air purifier may efficiently use power, and reduce an amount of power received from the external power source.

[0345] According to the disclosure, an air purifier including a solar cell and a battery, and a method of controlling the air purifier may be provided. Accordingly, an amount of power received by the air purifier from an external power source may be reduced.

[0346] According to the disclosure, an air purifier with a solar cell rotationally movable toward the sun, and a method of controlling the air purifier may be provided. Accordingly, efficiency of solar power of the air purifier may be improved.

[0347] According to the disclosure, an air purifier for receiving power from one of a battery and an external power source based on a charge rate of the battery, and a method of controlling the air purifier may be provided. Accordingly, efficiency of battery use of the air purifier may be improved.

[0348] Meanwhile, the embodiments of the disclosure may be implemented in the form of a recording medium for storing instructions to be carried out by a computer. The instructions may be stored in the form of program codes, and when executed by a processor, may generate program modules to perform operation in the embodiments of the disclosure. The recording media may correspond to computer-readable recording media.

[0349] The computer-readable recording medium includes any type of recording medium having data stored thereon that may be thereafter read by a computer. For example, it may be a ROM, a RAM, a magnetic tape, a magnetic disk, a flash memory, an optical data storage device, etc.

[0350] The machine-readable storage medium may be provided in the form of a non-transitory storage medium. The term 'non-transitory storage medium' may mean a tangible device without including a signal, e.g., electromagnetic waves, and may not distinguish between storing data in the storage medium semi-permanently and temporarily. For example, the non-transitory storage medium may include a buffer that temporarily stores data.

[0351] In an embodiment of the disclosure, the aforementioned method according to the various embodiments of the disclosure may be provided in a computer program product. The computer program product may be a commercial product that may be traded between a seller and a buyer. The computer program product may be distributed in the form of a storage medium (e.g., a compact disc read only memory (CD-ROM)), through an application store (e.g., playstore™),

directly between two user devices (e.g., smart phones), or online (e.g., downloaded or uploaded). In the case of online distribution, at least part of the computer program product (e.g., a downloadable app) may be at least temporarily stored or arbitrarily created in a storage medium that may be readable to a device such as a server of the manufacturer, a server of the application store, or a relay server.

[0352] While the disclosure has been shown and described with reference to certain exemplary embodiments thereof, it will be understood by those skilled in the art that various changes in form and details may be made therein without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure as defined by the appended claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. An air purifier comprising: a main body configured to be rotatable and including an inlet and an outlet; a fan arranged in the main body and configured to suck air into the main body through the inlet and discharge the air through the outlet; a solar cell configured to generate power from light received by the solar cell, the solar cell arranged on a first side of the main body, the first side extending along a first plane; a first light sensor arranged on a second side of the main body and configured to measure an intensity of light received by the first sensor, the second side extending along a second plane, the first plane and the second plane being different from each other; a second light sensor configured to measure an intensity of light received by the second light sensor, the second light sensor arranged on a third side of the main body, the third side extending along a third plane, the third plane being different from the first plane and the second plane; a driver configured to rotate the main body; and a processor configured to: control the fan to suck air into the main body through the inlet and discharge the air out of the main body through the outlet, and control the driver to rotate the main body based on an output signal from the first light sensor corresponding to the measured intensity of light received by the first light sensor and an output signal from the second light sensor corresponding to the measured intensity of light received by the second light sensor so that the solar cell is positioned toward a light source.
2. The air purifier of claim 1, wherein the processor is configured to rotate the main body so that the first side on which the solar cell is arranged faces a light incidence direction of the light source, based on a difference between the output signal of the first light sensor and the output signal of the second light sensor.
3. The air purifier of claim 2, wherein the processor is configured to rotate the main body so that the first side is rotated to a direction in which the second side is arranged, based on a magnitude of the output signal of the first light sensor being larger than a magnitude of the output signal of the second light sensor.
4. The air purifier of claim 1, wherein the inlet is arranged to surround the solar cell.
5. The air purifier of claim 1, further comprising: a contamination sensor configured to output a signal corresponding to a density of contaminants in the air, a battery electrically connected to the solar cell, and a power circuit configured to supply power to the fan from one of the battery and an external power source, wherein the processor is configured to control the power circuit to supply power to the fan from one of the battery or the external power source based on an output signal from the contamination sensor and a charge rate of the battery.
6. The air purifier of claim 5, wherein the processor is configured to control the power circuit to provide power to the fan from the external power source based on a density of the contaminants based on the output signal of the contamination sensor being larger than a reference density and a charge rate of the battery being less than a reference charge rate.
7. The air purifier of claim 5, wherein the processor is configured to control the power circuit to provide power to the fan from the battery based on a density of the contaminants based on the output signal of the contamination sensor being less than a reference density and a charge rate of

the battery being larger than a reference charge rate.

8. The air purifier of claim 1, further comprising: a first connector arranged on the top side of the main body to be connected to a first device, and a second connector arranged on the bottom side of the main body to be connected to a second device.

9. The air purifier of claim 1, wherein the driver is configured to rotate the main body around the second connector.

10. The air purifier of claim 8, further comprising: a communication module configured to communicate with the first device or the second device, wherein the processor is configured to receive a charge rate of a battery of the first device or the second device through the communication module.

11. The air purifier of claim 10, wherein the processor is configured to transmit power to the first device or the second device through the first connector or the second connector based on the charge rate of the battery of the first device or the second device.

12. The air purifier of claim 10, wherein the processor is configured to transmit power to the first device or the second device or to receive power from the first device or the second device, based on comparison between the charge rate of the battery of the first device or the second device and the charge rate of the battery of the air purifier.

13. A method of controlling an air purifier, the method comprising: sucking air into a main body through an inlet arranged at the main body; discharging air out of the main body through an outlet arranged at the main body; generating power using a solar cell arranged on a first side of the main body, the first side extending along a first plane; and rotating the main body so that the solar cell is positioned toward a light source, based on an output signal of a first light sensor, the output signal corresponding to an intensity of light received by the first light sensor, the first light sensor arranged on a second side of the main body, the second side extending along a second plane, the first plane being different from the second plane, and an output signal of a second light sensor, the output signal of the second light sensor corresponding to an intensity of light received by the second light sensor, the second light sensor arranged on a third side of the main body, the third side extending along a third plane, the third plane being different from the first plane and second plane.

14. The method of claim 13, wherein the rotating of the main body comprises rotating the main body so that the first side on which the solar cell is arranged faces a light incidence direction of a light source, based on a difference between the output signal of the first light sensor and the output signal of the second light sensor.

15. The method of claim 14, wherein the rotating of the main body comprises rotating the main body so that the first side is rotated to a direction in which the second side is arranged, based on a magnitude of the output signal of the first light sensor being larger than a magnitude of the output signal of the second light sensor.

16. The method of claim 14, further comprising: based on a charge rate of a battery electrically connected to the solar cell, supplying power to the fan from one of the battery or an external power source.

17. The method of claim 14, further comprising: based on an output signal from a contamination sensor sensing a density of contaminants in the air and a charge rate of a battery electrically connected to the solar cell, supplying power to the fan from one of a battery or an external power source.

18. The method of claim 17, wherein the supplying of the power to the fan from one of the battery or the external power source comprises: based on a density of contaminants based on the output signal from the contamination sensor being greater than a reference density and a charging rate of the battery being less than a reference rate, supplying power to the fan from the external power source.

19. The method of claim 17, wherein the supplying of the power to the fan from one of the battery or the external power source comprises based on a density of contaminants based on the output

signal from the contamination sensor being less than a reference density or a charging rate of the battery being greater than a reference rate, supplying power to the fan from the battery.
